

Beyond the humid clamour of Mumbai's coastline, the residence of Swedish Consul General Sven Östberg balances Nordic minimalism with the demands of diplomatic life. Moving into the space in August, 2025, Östberg has curated a home that serves a dual purpose: a sophisticated backdrop for high-level diplomacy and a warm, private sanctuary that keeps his roots alive. The home is a curated dialogue between Stockholm-designed furniture and a serene, bone-white palette, creating a calm refuge from the frantic energy of the city.

A Tale of Two Quarters

The residence is a thoughtful study in division. While the downstairs area is dedicated to official functions, the upstairs remains a deeply personal retreat. "The downstairs, the official part, was already provided furnished," Östberg explains. "But on the upstairs, that's our private part, we use our own furniture that we've brought from back home." This private level houses a cosy library, a small kitchenette and bedrooms, offering the Consul General and his wife a slice of Sweden in the middle of Maharashtra.

Curated by Stockholm

In the official wings of the home, every piece of furniture tells a story of heritage and state-sanctioned style. Unlike a typical home where the resident chooses the decor, this space is a gallery of Swedish excellence directed from afar. "We are actually not allowed to do any changes," says Östberg. "The furniture and all the artwork are decided by Stockholm... by the Ministry."

The rooms are a 'who's who' of Swedish design, featuring iconic sofas from Norell and Svenskt Tenn and chairs from Källemo and Lammhults. The aesthetic is strictly Scandinavian, a sea of muted beiges and whites. However, Östberg points out the intentional pops of character: "In a sea of muted colours, we have some islands of colours, statement pieces, for instance, the chairs and sofas in very bright blue shades."

The Perfect Bridge

The residence is designed for fluidity, transitioning effortlessly from one-on-one business meetings to grand Nobel receptions. To accommodate the massive crowds that flock to Swedish

NORDIC NUANCE
Consul General Sven Östberg in his living room (previous page); the dining table steals the spotlight in the dining room (above); a white and blue ceramic artefact (below)

